Dutiable goods

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Duties and Dutiable Goods Overview

Learn which goods are subject to duty in Singapore, how duties are calculated, and the categories of dutiable and non-dutiable goods.

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In Singapore, certain goods are subject to customs duty and/or excise duty when imported or manufactured.

Customs Duty: Levied on imported goods.

Excise Duty: Levied on goods manufactured in, or imported into, Singapore.

Goods not subject to customs or excise duty are non-dutiable, although GST may still apply unless exempted.

Types of Duty Rates

Duties are charged using either:

Ad valorem rate – A percentage of the goods’ customs value Example: 20% of customs value

Specific rate – A fixed amount per unit of weight or quantity Example: S$535 per kilogramme

Categories of Dutiable Goods

There are four categories:

Intoxicating liquors

Tobacco products

Motor vehicles

Petroleum products and biodiesel blends

Refer to the list of dutiable goods for the specific duty rates.

Examples of Duty Calculation

Below are examples showing how duties are calculated for each category.

1. Intoxicating liquors

a) Liquors charged per litre of alcohol

Formula Duties payable = Total quantity (litres) × (Customs duty + Excise duty) × Alcoholic strength (%)

Example Company A imports 75 litres of stout with 5% alcohol strength. Customs duty = S$16 per litre of alcohol Excise duty = S$60 per litre of alcohol

Duties payable = 75 × (16 + 60) × 5% = S$285

b) Liquors charged on dutiable content (weight/volume)

Formula Duties payable = Dutiable content (kg) × Customs duty rate

Example 1 kg of alcoholic composite concentrate contains 0.2 kg of powdered alcohol. Customs duty = S$113 per kg Duties payable = 0.2 × 113 = S$22.60

2. Tobacco Products

a) All tobacco products except cigarettes

Formula Duties payable = Weight (kg) × Excise duty rate

Example Company A imports 100 kg of tobacco stems. Excise duty = S$535 per kg Duties payable = 100 × 535 = S$53,500

b) Cigarettes

Formula Duties payable = Number of sticks × Weight per stick (rounded up to nearest gramme) × Excise duty rate

Example Company A imports 100 sticks weighing 1.5 g each. Duty rate = S$0.589 per gramme per stick Weight is rounded up to 2 grammes. Duties payable = 100 × 2 × 0.589 = S$117.80

3. Motor vehicles

Formula Duties payable = Customs value × Excise duty rate

Example Company A imports a motor car that was bought at S$100,000 on Free on Board (FOB) incoterms. Freight, handling, insurance = S$1,000 Customs value of car = S$101,000 Excise duty = 20% Duties payable = 101,000 × 20% = S$20,200

4. Petroleum products and biodiesel blends

a) Petroleum products

Formula Duties payable = Volume × Excise duty rate

Example Company A imports 100 litres of unleaded, unblended motor spirit (RON 97+). Duty rate = S$7.90 per dal (1 dal = 10 litres)

Volume in dal = 100 ÷ 10 = 10 dal Duties payable = 7.90 × 10 = S$79

b) Compressed natural gas (Cng)

Formula Duties payable = Weight (kg) × Excise duty rate

Example Company A imports 50 kg of Cng. Duty rate = S$0.20 per kg Duties payable = 50 × 0.20 = S$10

c) Biodiesel blends

Formula Duties payable = Volume of diesel × Excise duty rate

Example Company A imports 1,000 litres of biodiesel blend containing 100 litres of diesel. Duty rate = S$2.00 per dal (1 dal = 10 litres)

Volume in dal = 100 ÷ 10 = 10 dal Duties payable = 2 × 10 = S$20